Privacy Policy

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1. Who we are and how to reach us

gcsebusiness (“we”, “us”) operates gcse.business, a quiz and revision platform for Edexcel GCSE (9–1) Business used in schools. Questions about this policy or about your data can be sent to hello@gcsebusiness.co.uk — please mark data-protection enquiries “Data protection”.

Where your school provides the platform, responsibility is split: we are the controller for teacher accounts and for running the service, while the school is the controller for its students’ data and we process that data on the school’s behalf under our Data Processing Agreement (available on request, and printed alongside this policy).

2. The short version

- We collect only what the platform needs to run: names and usernames, logins, quiz work and progress.
- No advertising, no tracking cookies, no analytics profiles — and your data is never sold.
- Student data lives in the EU, on Google Firebase, encrypted in transit.
- Written answers are marked by AI — we send the answer text, and nothing that identifies the student (details in §5).
- Schools can delete students and classes at any time; everything else is deleted within 30 days of the licence ending.

3. What we collect

Teacher and staff accounts. Your full name, school email address and a password. Passwords are stored only as a salted scrypt hash — even we cannot read or recover them.

Student accounts. A username, a display name, class membership and a password, all set up by the school. Student passwords are also held in an encrypted form the class teacher can view and re-issue, so a forgotten login never has to stop a lesson — which is why students must never reuse a password from any other service on this platform.

Work and progress. Quiz answers (including written answers), marks and mark-scheme breakdowns, completion and timing information, streaks and badges, avatar choices, feedback text and in-app notifications.

Technical records. A single essential sign-in cookie (httpOnly, 30 days), preferences such as dark mode and unfinished drafts stored locally in the browser, and short-lived server logs kept for security and troubleshooting.

What we never collect. Students' email addresses, phone numbers, home addresses, dates of birth or payment card details (invoicing is handled by email), precise location, or anything used to build advertising profiles.

4. Where your data lives, and for how long

Account and work data is stored in Google Firebase's Realtime Database, hosted in the EU (europe-west1 region). Data is kept while the licence is active. Teachers can delete students and classes at any time from the dashboard; everything else is deleted within 30 days of the licence ending or of a written request from the school.

5. AI marking, feedback and quiz generation — exactly what is sent

Some marking and feedback is performed by AI through our providers (Google Gemini, Groq and Z.ai). Connections are encrypted, and each request carries only what the task needs:

- **To mark a written answer:** the question, its mark scheme and the answer text — no name or identifier is attached.
- **To write feedback:** the student's display name (as set by the teacher), the quiz title, the score and the topic breakdown.
- **To generate a quiz:** only the teacher's brief and chosen topics — no student data at all.

Our providers' API terms restrict the use of submitted content to processing the request.

6. How we protect it

- Every connection uses HTTPS/TLS.
- Teacher passwords are scrypt-hashed with a unique salt per password.
- Teacher-recoverable student logins use AES-256-GCM encryption.
- Sessions are HMAC-SHA-256-signed, httpOnly cookies.
- Every request is authorisation-checked on the server, and the database is protected by security rules.
- Access to the production system is limited to the operator.

7. Who else can see it

We never sell personal data, and we never share it for advertising or marketing. We use a short list of sub-processors — Google LLC (Firebase, EU-hosted database; Gemini, AI marking), Groq Inc. (AI marking) and Zhipu AI / Z.ai (AI marking) — listed in full in the Data Processing Agreement. We would disclose data only if legally compelled, and we would tell the school wherever the law allows us to.

8. Your rights

Under the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018 you can ask to access, correct, delete, restrict or object to the processing of your data, or ask for a portable copy. Students normally exercise these rights through their school. We

respond within one calendar month. If you are unhappy with our answer you may complain to the Information Commissioner’s Office (ico.org.uk, 0303 123 1113).

9. Children

The platform is designed for 14–16 year-olds and is delivered through schools: there is no profiling, no behavioural advertising, no in-app purchasing, and we limit data to what the classroom needs. We follow the ICO’s Age Appropriate Design Code principles. Any parental consents are the school’s to obtain as controller.

10. International transfers

The primary database is in the EU. The AI providers in §5 may process the limited content described there outside the UK or EEA, only under their enterprise API terms with appropriate safeguards. No full student records are ever transferred.

11. Changes to this policy

We post the current version on this page and notify schools by email of material changes. Continuing to use the platform after a change takes effect means accepting it.
